



**State Employment  
Leadership Network**

## Monthly Network Meeting

January 17, 2018

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### SELN Monthly Network Meeting: January 17, 2018

#### AGENDA

##### Welcome to everyone!

1. Brief intros
2. Housekeeping

##### Project Business

1. **Systems Change in Tennessee to Promote Employment First**  
**Jennifer Bose**, Research staff, Institute for Community Inclusion  
**Shannon Nehus**, IDD Long Term Care Program Director, Bureau of TennCare  
**Dr. Lisa Mills**, Deputy Chief of Long-Term Services and Supports, Bureau of TennCare  
**Jeremy Norden-Paul**, Director of Employment and Day Services,  
Department of Intellectual and Developmental Disabilities (DIDD)  
**Wanda Willis**, Executive Director, Tennessee Council on Developmental Disabilities
2. **Upcoming Network meetings** (60 minutes, all 3pm ET)
  - February 21<sup>st</sup>
  - March 21<sup>st</sup>
  - April 18<sup>th</sup>
  - May 16<sup>th</sup>
  - June 20<sup>th</sup>

Stay up to date and in the loop: [www.selnhub.org](http://www.selnhub.org)



## Access to Integrated Employment Project

Collecting data on employment  
trends and practices at all levels

Rehabilitation Research and Training Center on Advancing Employment  
for Individuals with Intellectual and Developmental Disabilities

A project of

**ThinkWork!**  
at the Institute for Community Inclusion, UMass Boston



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## Studies at the state level

- Promising practices in employment
- Promising practices in community life engagement
- Employment First case studies

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## Employment First propositions

All individuals with IDD:

- Are capable of performing work in typical integrated employment settings
- Should receive as a matter of state policy employment-related services and supports as a priority over other facility-based and non-work day services
- Should be paid at minimum or prevailing wage rates

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## Support for Employment First

- Department of Labor
- Department of Justice
- Center for Medicare and Medicaid Services
- State and local agreements between agencies and VR mandated by WIOA

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## Higher Performing Framework



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